

Joel Watlington

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Current Address : Manchester, NH

Online Portfolio : joelwatlington.com

QUALIFICATIONS

Achievements

- Top-secret Clearance with SCI eligibility (2021) (exp. Aug. 2026)
- CompTIA Security+ Certification (2025) (exp. Jan. 2028)
- CompTIA Server+ Certification (2025) (Good For Life)
- Given formal congratulations after presenting the first automated test case under DSI (2025)
- Nominated for a CARES award at the State of Maine (2023)

Techniques

- Highly technical knowledge through **Cloud**, **DevOps**, **Web Development** and **Automation**
- Leadership and communication experience using **agile methodology** and **Jira** through user stories, tickets, and Kanban boards
- Documentation skills through numerous **Confluence** pages including complete coverage of Eggplant automation, Ansible playbooks, and missile defense software for onsite servers

Software

- **AWS Cloud** – Architected secure cloud infrastructure utilizing IAM roles, Route 53 DNS routing, and security groups; Engineered automated AMI pipelines, deployed Lambda functions, and managed company wide operations through the AWS console
- **Docker** – Utilized docker commands to streamline programming functionality under Wright Patterson AFB and Kforce to improve deployment flow, programming control, and a baseline for all operations
- **Gitlab CI/CD**, **Gitlab runners**, and **YAML** – Deployed Gitlab runners that executed jobs to create service containers, security tests, and unit tests for pushing data into Jfrog while working under Wright Patterson AFB and Kforce
- **Jenkins** – Crafted a large software feature under DSI to scan every new file that had been pushed for vulnerabilities using Coverity. Additionally supported new pipeline functionality for automation while communicating 24/7 automation to the information systems security manager
- **Kubernetes** – Delegated a Kubernetes clusters, nodes, and pods to allow for scalability in resources for Docker containers and software while working under Wright Patterson AFB
- **Ansible** – Guided Ansible playbooks under Kforce to dynamically allocate user accounts, streamline patching while also displaying critical version information, and organized health status scripts to replace Puppet licensing through the creation of systemd jobs

- **Terraform** – Designed a completely new terraform structure under Kforce so that AWS console implementation would not only be consistent but more secure through the alteration of security groups
- **Kafka** and **Zookeeper** – Deployed multi-node message brokers and managed Zookeeper states to ensure seamless cluster coordination, topic creation, and fault-tolerant data streaming under Kforce
- **Git** and **Bitbucket** – Organized, deployed, and collaborated with multiple different teams across many different repositories through all past work experiences
- **Linux/Bash** – Actively programmed using bash scripting in addition to strong familiarity with the Linux operating system to support team development through all past employers
- **Rocky Linux Distribution** – Acutely created CRON jobs and managed file permissions under Wright Patterson AFB
- **Angular** – reliably worked tickets under a large team with the federal government developing a full-stack application to meet expectations of multiple product owners
- **JavaScript** – Manipulated JavaScript for various data changes in the federal government and the CDC
- **Java** – Successfully crafted back-end functionality for API calls using Java while working for the federal government
- **C#** – Utilized **ASP.NET** and **ASP Classic** framework to maintain programs using C# and have a strong grasp of the language throughout working with the State of Maine
- **C++** – Under Wright Patterson Cpp files were used for version control and mathematical programming so that unit testing functioned properly
- **Python** – Built multiple scripts i.e. manipulating **JSON** and **NDJSON** files under the Elasticsearch team. Supported python scripting to aid in automating eggplant by generating log files
- **Eggplant** – Established test cases, scripts, and drivers under DSI through eggplant coding to allow automated flow through product lines
- **SQL Developer**, **PostgreSQL**, and **SQL Server Management Studio** – Has no problem fixing database related issues or mapping large database tables for programming new functionality
- **Postman** – Resourcefully used postman for testing and debugging website API calls throughout my experience as a web developer
- **React.js**, **Next.js**, and **Tailwind** – easily created my portfolio using powerful react customization
- **Kibana**, **EQL**, and **Lucene** – Competently developed tickets through the Elasticsearch team by organizing data and creating install packages
- **FileZilla** – Independently tested, developed, and released code using FileZilla to manage development, test, and production environments

WORK EXPERIENCE

Kforce – **Mid-Level Cloud Developer** | Huntsville, AL (Mar. 2026 – May 2026)

- Engineered an automated Gitlab CI/CD pipeline using Docker-in-Docker to dynamically build Amazon machine images for Ansible deployments
- Refactored and modularized Terraform to optimize readability and scalability for cloud security groups while also hardening cloud security by changing CIDR-based rules into strict role-based rules
- Streamlined patch management, user provisioning, and health monitoring by designing multiple Ansible playbooks; successfully eliminating Puppet license requirements to generate significant cost savings
- Deployed and optimized Apache Kafka clusters within AWS, configuring underlying Zookeeper dependencies, and automated topic creation to facilitate high-throughput real-time data streaming

Davis Strategic Innovations – **Automation Engineer Lead** | Huntsville, AL (Sept. 2024 – Feb. 2026)

- Over a year and a half of experience developing DevOps pipelines through Jenkins
- Concurrently creating automation software by using Eggplant and Python for the purpose of allowing faster, more accurate programming flow
- Orchestrated presentation skills through creating videos to demonstrate competence for government customers. Teaching experience by instructing an entire team how to use Eggplant software for aiding automation efforts
- Assisted Coworkers, Scrum Master, Product Owner, and Technical Lead by creating Jira stories, providing feedback, and aiding in work management as a professional team leader that changed company flow
- Hands-on experience working with the integration team to produce Ansible playbooks that facilitated software installation through automated means

Insight Global – **DevOps Engineer** | Dayton, OH (Feb. 2024 – Aug. 2024)

- Six months of experience professionally building and debugging Gitlab pipelines to create a more efficient project environment to house service containers with security information and testing data
- Optimized Docker container images by minimizing package dependencies, successfully reducing image footprint and accelerating cluster pull times
- Streamlined application deployment on Kubernetes clusters by designing and managing dynamic Helm charts. Integrated Helm chart deployments into an automated CI/CD pipeline using GitLab
- Consistently navigating Jfrog artifactory to solve dependency issues for key libraries and programming Cpp / Hpp files to allow correct mathematical flow

State of Maine – **Computer Programmer** | Augusta, ME (June 2023 – Nov. 2023)

- Six months of experience assisting clients by maintaining web applications through removing bugs, creating features, pushing releases, and communicating expectations
- Frequently monitoring emails to aid clients regarding software installations, database fixes, or general usage in a timely, polite, and intelligent way
- Succinctly learning cybersecurity and programming techniques throughout over 40 hours of professional training

Robins Air Force Base – Elasticsearch Engineer | Warner Robins, GA (July 2021 – Mar. 2023)

- A year and nine months of experience implementing Elasticsearch to create custom Elastic Integration Packages for enterprise clients by parsing complex data structures, optimizing file-trees, and mapping data points to the Elastic Common Schema
- Architected Logstash data pipelines to ingest, prune, and normalize high-volume datasets for accuracy and clean data delivery
- Developed interactive Kibana dashboards and deployed Machine Learning to transform raw log data into insightful analysis
- Succinctly developed a large government full stack application to house large sets of data across the country

EDUCATION

Tennessee Technological University – Cookeville, TN (May 2021)

- Bachelor of Science in Computer Science
- Cumulative GPA: 3.54 Graduated with Cum Laude

Motlow State Community College – Tullahoma, TN (May 2018)

- Associates of Science in Chemistry
- GPA: 3.94